



Stretchable battery for wearables

Stanford scientists have developed a new, flexible power source, especially useful for wearables. <https://digit.in/feb20-69>



Iron Man VR delayed

Developer Camouflaj confirmed that Marvel's Iron Man VR game for the PS4 has been delayed to May 15. <https://digit.in/feb20-70>

Beyerdynamic Lagoon ANC

Misses the mark when it comes to ANC

The Beyerdynamic Lagoon ANC is the company's offering in the premium wireless headphones segment. Priced exorbitantly at ₹29,990, the cans go up against acclaimed headphones, from other established audio brands, such as the Bose NC 700, Sony WH-1000XM3, and Jabra Elite 85H. We put these cans to test and let's see what the results are.

Build and design

Upon unboxing, you'll find a swanky looking, teardrop-shaped, hard case with the Beyerdynamic logo stamped right in the middle. Within the case, you'll find the headphones, a USB Type-C cable and a 3.5mm audio connector.

These circumaural headphones certainly ooze a premium look even though they are predominantly made out of plastic. There's plush memory foam on both, the headband and earcups, making them an extremely comfortable pair of headphones to wear. The headphones can also be extended a fair bit and have steel reinforcements within. However, even at their most compact, the Lagoon ANC might be a bit too large for smaller heads. The earcups can be rotated 90 degrees and folded upwards to aid portability. On the right earcup, you have all your physical buttons, touch controls and ports.

Features

You have two different ANC modes - Level 1 dims the external sounds faintly while Level 2 is the maximum level. There's also an LGS or light guide system. Basically, the inner part of the earcups glows a different colour to deliver visual prompts such as Power On, Pairing mode, etc much like voice prompts on most wireless headphones.

The cans also feature a hybrid control system which comprises of some physical controls as well as touch controls. The touch controls lie on the right earcup and are intuitive. The sensitiv-



ity seems to be too high since it is prone to registering false touches. Still, the touch controls worked quite well for the most part. However, we absolutely couldn't get the 'Fast Forward' and 'Rewind' controls to work no matter how many times we tried.

Lastly, the headphones can be tuned on the accompanying app to your specific hearing ability. While it didn't necessarily tweak our music-listening experience too much, this can be particularly useful for those with hearing disabilities. Unfortunately, the app doesn't include a customisable EQ.

Additional features include extra codec support such as Qualcomm aptX LL, aptX, and AAC; speech intelligibility using Qualcomm cVc; and wired (passive) usage. However, it uses Bluetooth version 4.2 instead of the industry standard 5.0, which is absurd at this price point and it also does not come with an IP rating.

Performance

Beyerdynamic is known for its audiophile-grade headphones with stellar sound profiles. The Beyerdynamic Lagoon ANC is no exception. The only thing lacking in this regard is the relatively narrow soundstage. Tracks

such as *Hotel California* by *The Eagles* sound compressed instead of extended. Nevertheless, the imaging is almost perfect. The headphones deliver solid low-frequency response, the bass has a strong thump to it. With ANC on, however, the bass gets a bit more body. The midrange has a certain emphasis on it as well which boosts the quality of vocals, guitars and their harmonic resonances. The highs are quite extended and detailed. In songs such as *Another One Bites the Dust* by *Queen*, the mid and low frequencies complement each other fantastically. Passive isolation is one of the weak elements of the headphones, however, what's even weaker is the ANC performance. It isn't bad by any means and performs relatively well in dulling out background sounds, however, it doesn't match the calibre of the Sony

WH-1000XM3 and the Bose NC 700. Battery life, on the other hand, is quite adequate. We managed to squeeze out about 23 hours with ANC on.

Bottomline

The Beyerdynamic Lagoon ANC headphones feature an appealing design. The sound quality is stellar, with boosted lows and mids and detailed highs. However, the soundstage is quite restrictive and ANC performance is lacklustre for the price. Still, if great sound quality and decent battery life are what you're after, the Beyerdynamic Lagoon ANC can be a great purchase. It would be an even better one if priced around 10K lower.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

TRANSDUCER TYPE: dynamic | OPERATING PRINCIPLE: closed | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 10 - 30,000 Hz | NOMINAL IMPEDANCE: 20 Ω | SPEAKER DIAMETER: 40 mm | ANC: yes | BLUETOOTH: Version 4.2 | RANGE: Up to 10m | NFC PAIRING: yes | BATTERY LIFE: 45h without ANC, 24.5h with ANC | WEIGHT: 283g

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